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## **Simulation of partial melting material**

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# **Simulation of partial melting material**

by  
**Chenyu Tian**

## **Dissertation**

Presented to the Faculty of the Graduate School of  
The University of Texas at Austin  
in Partial Fulfillment  
of the Requirements  
for the Degree of

**Doctor of Philosophy**

**The University of Texas at Austin**  
**May 2025**

# Dedication

To all future Longhorn graduate students.

## Epigraph

*What starts here changes the world.*

—University of Texas at Austin

# Acknowledgments

Thanks to the previous authors of this template, and to the Graduate School for providing it.

# Preface

Readers, this document represents a great deal of time and effort. Enjoy.  
Cheers, Chenyu Tian.

# **Abstract**

## **Simulation of partial melting material**

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# Table of Contents

|                                                   |    |
|---------------------------------------------------|----|
| List of Tables . . . . .                          | 10 |
| List of Figures . . . . .                         | 11 |
| Chapter 1: Governing Equations . . . . .          | 12 |
| 1.1 Mechanics of Mantle Dynamics . . . . .        | 12 |
| 1.2 Conservation of species and energy . . . . .  | 14 |
| 1.2.1 Effective Velocity . . . . .                | 15 |
| 1.3 Eutectic Phase Behavior . . . . .             | 15 |
| 1.4 Rescaling and Nondimensionalization . . . . . | 16 |
| Works Cited . . . . .                             | 17 |

## List of Tables

# List of Figures

|     |                                                 |    |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------|----|
| 1.1 | An representative volume element (RVE). . . . . | 14 |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------|----|

# Chapter 1: Governing Equations in Mantle Dynamics

## 1.1 Mechanics of Mantle Dynamics

Fluid dynamics of the mixture of two phase flow has been extensively discussed. We will discuss the three governing equations of mass and momentum referring to the similar discussion in Drew and Segel (1971), McKenzie (1984) and Katz (2022). Considering a conservation equation for given volumetric variable  $\gamma$  in a representative volume element  $V$ .

$$\frac{d}{dt} \int_V \gamma d\mathbf{v} = - \int_{\partial V} \mathbf{f} \cdot d\sigma + \int_V S d\mathbf{v} \quad (1.1)$$

where  $\mathbf{f}$  represents flux travelling across the boundary of a representative volume element  $V$ . The minus sign indicates that the positive directions aligns with normal unit vector pointing outwards.  $S$ , source/sink term, represents the volumetric production rate of  $\gamma$ . We can apply Gauss's theorem to obtain differential form,

$$\frac{\partial \gamma}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot \mathbf{f} = S \quad (1.2)$$

We also define the quantity of phase fraction rigorously with the help of an indicator function admitting that multiple phase cannot coexist at the same spatial point, which are regarded as immiscible phases. We define indicator function,

$$i(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{phase}_i \\ 0 & \text{not phase}_i \end{cases} \quad (1.3)$$

We then define macroscopic phase fraction function:

$$\phi_i = \frac{1}{\delta \mathbf{v}} \int_{\delta \mathbf{v}} i(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{v} \quad (1.4)$$

In the beginning of my discussion, We will discuss two immiscible phases liquid magma and solid mantle. Phase fraction of liquid magma is labelled as  $\phi_l$  and phase fraction

of solid mantle is labelled as  $\phi_s$ , where  $\phi_l + \phi_s = 1$  is always attained. Phase fraction can also be regarded as volume fraction in macroscopic sense.

Substituting bulk density  $\bar{\rho} = \phi_l \rho_l + \phi_s \rho_s$  for generalized volumetric variable  $\gamma$  in equation 1.1, we can obtain conservation law for bulk mass,

$$\frac{\partial \bar{\rho}}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot \bar{\rho} \mathbf{v} = 0 \quad (1.5)$$

with the help of Boussinesq approximation ignoring compressibility of each individual phase, and extend Boussinesq approximation further applying to density difference between each phase except body force term. We can write continuous function for two phase mixture simply as,

$$\nabla \cdot \bar{\mathbf{v}} = 0 \quad (1.6)$$

Substituting phase averaged momentum  $\bar{\rho} \mathbf{v}$ , We then write conservation of momentum with phase averaged term,

$$\frac{\partial \bar{\rho} \mathbf{v}}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot \overline{\rho \mathbf{v} \otimes \mathbf{v}} = \bar{\rho} \mathbf{g} + \nabla \cdot \bar{\boldsymbol{\tau}} - \nabla \bar{P} \quad (1.7)$$

where  $\boldsymbol{\tau}$  represents deviatoric stress, Ignoring change of inertia term due to near zero Reynolds number in magma and mantle,

$$\bar{\rho} \mathbf{g} + \nabla \cdot \bar{\boldsymbol{\tau}} - \nabla \bar{P} = 0 \quad (1.8)$$

Insert more details later!

Combining equations ...., I finally arrive with the full flow mechanical system,

$$\phi_f (\mathbf{v}_l - \mathbf{v}_s) + \frac{k_{\phi_l}}{\mu_l} \nabla (p_l - p_f \mathbf{g}) = 0, \quad (1.9)$$

$$\nabla \cdot (\phi_l \mathbf{v}_l + \phi_s \mathbf{v}_s) = 0, \quad (1.10)$$

$$\nabla \bar{p} - \nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{\tau}(\mathbf{v}_s) = (\rho_s - \rho_l) \mathbf{g}, \quad (1.11)$$

$$\mu_s \nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_s - \phi_f (p_l - p_s) = 0, \quad (1.12)$$

where the deviatoric stress of the mixture is

$$\tau(\mathbf{v}_s) = 2\mu_s\phi_s(\mathcal{D}\mathbf{v}_s - \frac{1}{3}\nabla \cdot \mathbf{v}_s\mathbf{I}) \quad (1.13)$$

and  $\mathcal{D}\mathbf{v}_s = \frac{1}{2}(\nabla\mathbf{v}_s + \nabla\mathbf{v}_s^T)$  is the symmetric gradient. Moreover, the relative permeability is  $k_{\phi_l} = k_0\phi_l^{2+2\Theta}$ , where  $\Theta \in [0, 1/2]$ .  $\mu_s$  and  $\mu_l$  are dynamic viscosities for solid and liquid correspondingly.

## 1.2 Conservation of species and energy

Chemical compositions of mantle and magma is very complicate and very hard to trace at the same time. We simplify the model to a two-phase system with two species. We negelect detailed description of chemical reaction process and effect on the Gibbs free energies. Similar discussion can be found in extensive literatures like Spiegelman and Elliott (1993), Hewitt and Fowler (2008), Katz (2008) and Marc A. Hesse and Oza (2022). Both two species can be solid or liquid. Two species are immiscible as solid but miscible as liquid. I consider a homogenous density  $\rho_s$  for solid phase and  $\rho_l$  for liquid phase. Within the representative volume element  $V$ ,

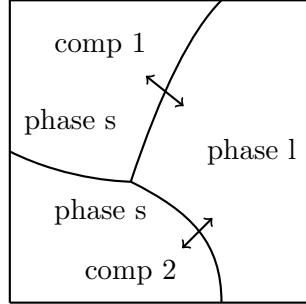


Figure 1.1: An representative volume element (RVE).

$\gamma_{i,j}$  represents one quantity of the specie  $i$  presenting in phase  $j$ , where  $i \in 1, 2$  and  $j \in \{s, l\}$ . The mass fraction  $c_{i,j}$  of a given specie  $i$  in phase  $j$  is often regarded as concentration. Hence, we can write transport equations for a individual specie  $i$

assuming a pseudo melting term  $\Gamma$ ,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\phi_l \rho_l c_{i,l}) + \nabla \cdot (\phi_l \rho_l c_{i,l} \mathbf{v}_l - \phi_l \rho_l \mathcal{D}_i \nabla c_{i,l}) = \Gamma_i \quad (1.14)$$

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\phi_s \rho_s c_{i,s}) + \nabla \cdot (\phi_s \rho_s c_{i,s} \mathbf{v}_s - \phi_s \rho_s \mathcal{D}_i \nabla c_{i,s}) = -\Gamma_i \quad (1.15)$$

where we can safely get rid of dissusion term in solid phase. Summing up equation 1.14 and equation 1.15, we can write a advection-diffusion equation in phase averaged volumetric bulk variable,

$$\frac{\partial \overline{\rho c_i}}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\overline{\rho c_i} \mathbf{v} - \phi_l \rho_l \mathcal{D}_i \nabla c_i) = 0 \quad (1.16)$$

where the phase averaged volumetric bulk variable are defined as  $\overline{\rho c_i} = \sum_{j \in \{s,l\}} \phi_j \rho_j c_{i,j}$  and  $\overline{\rho c_i} \mathbf{v} = \sum_{j \in \{s,l\}} \phi_j \rho_j c_{i,j} \mathbf{v}_j$ .

### 1.2.1 Effective Velocity

Effective velocity for concentration in liquid phase is discussed in ?. We also introduce our effective velocity, but instead, we transport bulk concentration. Define partition coefficient  $D = c_s/c_f$  and

$$(\phi_l + \phi_s D) c_{i,l} = \bar{c}_i \quad (1.17)$$

$$(\phi_l/D + \phi_s) c_{i,s} = \bar{c}_i \quad (1.18)$$

Substitute  $c_{i,l}$  and  $c_{i,s}$  with equation 1.17 and equation 1.18 into bulk velocity  $\overline{c_i} \mathbf{v} = \phi_s \mathbf{v}_s c_{i,s} + \phi_l \mathbf{v}_l c_{i,l}$ ,

$$\overline{c_i} \mathbf{v} = \phi_s \mathbf{v}_s c_{i,s} + \phi_l \mathbf{v}_l c_{i,l} = \left( \frac{\phi_l \mathbf{v}_l + D \phi_s \mathbf{v}_s}{\phi_l + \phi_s D} \right) \bar{c}_i \quad (1.19)$$

Hence, we get the proper expression for the effective velocity as  $v_{\text{eff}} = \frac{\phi_l \mathbf{v}_l + D \phi_s \mathbf{v}_s}{\phi_l + \phi_s D}$

## 1.3 Eutectic Phase Behavior

The enthalpy method requires an explicit relationship between temperature and enthalpy. Embracing the fact that Mid-ocean ridge forms at the place where

temperature is generally lower, eutectic melting, where melting temperature is significantly lowered with the presence of the secondary specie, is a good model for modelling melting behavior at certain location. The binary eutectic phase behavior describes the chemical behavior of two immiscible crystals from a completely miscible solution. On a typical eutectic phase behavior diagram, we can locate any phase situation using enthalpy and composition information. I follow phase behavior details described in Marc A. Hesse and Oza (2022). Some adjustments and assumptions are made for our partially molten mantle system.

- The composition of the second specie in the liquid formed by eutectic melting  $X_e$  is a function of pressure.
- Melting temperature  $T_m$  is a function of pressure.

Following the previous discussion,

## 1.4 Rescaling and Nondimensionalization



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